



SESSION 6: MENTOR GUIDE

My role models

Who someone admires tells you more than you could directly ask. Listen to the qualities, not the names.

SESSION GOAL

Use role models to reveal what the athlete deeply desires for themselves. Role models are mirrors of inner longing.

CONVERSATION FLOW**OPENING (5 MIN)**

“If you think of one person who truly inspires you, who comes to mind immediately?”

💡 The spontaneous name is the real one. Then ask: “What exactly about them?”

EXPLORING (15 MIN)

“What do the people you admire have in common? What theme do you see?”

💡 Let the athlete discover the pattern themselves. That's more powerful than you naming it.

DEEPENING (10 MIN)

“Do you already have that quality in yourself? Or is it something you want to become?”

💡 This opens a conversation about aspiration and identity development.

CLOSING (5 MIN)

“Are you a role model for someone in your circle? How does that feel?”

💡 Many athletes never think about this. It can be a powerful moment of self-worth.

OBSERVE

- Does the athlete choose role models from sport only, or also outside? (Narrow vs. broad self-image)
- Are the admired qualities performance-focused (winning, fast) or character-focused (perseverance, honesty)?
- How does the athlete react to the question of whether they are a role model themselves? Shyness or pride?
- Which qualities the athlete admires do YOU already see in them, that they don't see themselves?

△ NOTE

Role models can also be toxic (perfect athletes who hide their struggles). If the athlete has an unrealistically unattainable image, help nuance it: "What do you know about their difficult moments?"

CLOSING

"What if I tell you that I already see [quality X] in you?" Name something concrete you have observed. This is a gift you give as a mentor.

MENTOR NOTES